

IBM Cloud Databases

Fully Managed Open-Source Databases on IBM Cloud

IBM Service Proposal

1. Supported Engines & Technology Stack

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, etcd, RabbitMQ, Cassandra (via partners)
Compatible with standard drivers, ORMs, and tooling for the listed engines.

2. SLA, Uptime & High Availability

SLA: 99.99% for highly available configurations.

Architecture: Multi-AZ deployments with automatic failover. Read replicas for supported engines.

RPO/RTO: RPO near-zero; RTO minutes depending on engine.

Multi-region and clustering options available where noted.

3. Encryption, Security & Compliance

Encryption: Encryption at rest (provider-managed or BYOK via Key Protect/Hyper Protect). TLS in transit.

Certifications: SOC 2, ISO 27001, PCI DSS, HIPAA, FedRAMP, GDPR, CSA STAR

IAM: IBM Cloud IAM, App ID, private endpoints, VPC.

Audit logging and customer-managed keys supported on applicable tiers.

4. Performance Characteristics

Dedicated deployments. Autoscaling storage. High IOPS options. Connection pooling built-in for some.

5. Scaling (Vertical / Horizontal / Auto)

Vertical scaling of resources. Horizontal for supported engines. Autoscaling storage.

6. Backup, Recovery & Disaster Recovery

Automated continuous backups. PITR where supported. Cross-region options.

Replication and failover capabilities as described in HA section. Service credits available for SLA breaches per policy.

7. Pricing Model & Additional Fees

Hourly based on memory/disk/IOPS. Reserved capacity discounts. Free tier limited.

Additional / Hidden Fees: Network egress, backup storage beyond included, snapshot storage, premium support, data transfer between regions/clouds, CMEK/KMS usage.

Reserved / Committed Discounts: Committed use discounts and enterprise agreements available via IBM account team.

8. Observability, Monitoring & Slow Query Analysis

IBM Cloud Monitoring, Log Analysis, Activity Tracker, database-specific metrics.

Most platforms provide slow-query logs, explain plans, and recommendation engines.

9. Support Tiers & Response Times

Standard, Premium, Advanced. 24/7 for paid. Response times by severity.

10. Data Migration & Tooling

IBM Lift, native tools, partner DMS solutions.

11. Network, VPC/Private Access & Peering

Private endpoints, VPC, Direct Link. Egress fees.

12. Data Center / Region Locations

Dallas, Washington DC, Frankfurt, London, Tokyo, Sydney, Montreal, Sao Paulo, Mumbai (limited services).

13. Vendor Lock-in & Portability

Where standard engines (Postgres, MySQL, Redis protocols) are used, portability is high via dump/restore or logical replication. Proprietary extensions or distributed SQL semantics may require more effort. Open standards and export tools mitigate lock-in.

14. Managed Service Limitations

Feature parity varies by engine; some advanced open-source features may lag.

15. Maintenance & Backup Windows

Customer-configurable or provider-managed low-impact maintenance. Backup windows typically continuous or daily with minimal performance impact.

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